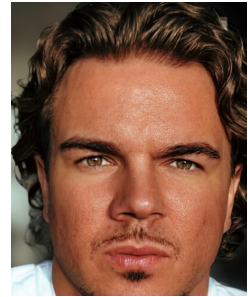


CHARLIE OWEN

Commercial Strategy & International Business Development

UK Market Development · Enterprise Business Development · Commercial Transformation

London, United Kingdom | charlie@meridianelevate.co.uk | 07466 639560
linkedin.com/in/charlieowen-commercial



EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Senior commercial and business development professional with 12+ years of experience spanning UK market development, enterprise business development, commercial transformation, sales operations and talent development. Combines analytical commercial diagnosis with strong stakeholder insight, using data to identify performance gaps before examining the organisational, behavioural and cultural factors behind them.

Career includes ownership of UK commercial strategy for a Spanish 4PL logistics group, transformation of a lean business development function, development of major enterprise opportunities, and five years of independent consulting across sales operations, commercial performance and learning development. Now Founder of Meridian Elevate, focused on helping established international businesses build credible commercial foundations in the UK.

80k → 300k

sq. ft. expansion of ICP
Logística's UK operation
during tenure

£2m+

named B2B logistics
opportunity originated and
developed

30+

recruitment consultants
recruited, trained and
developed

12+ yrs

commercial, business
development and
people-development
experience

CORE COMMERCIAL CAPABILITIES

Commercial Strategy	Enterprise Account Development	UK Market Entry
Sales Operations & CRM	Pipeline & KPI Management	Tender & Proposal Development
Commercial Intelligence	Stakeholder Mapping	BDR Leadership & Coaching
Learning & Development	Opportunity Diagnosis	Partnership Development

SELECTED CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- ICP Logística: progressively restructured the UK commercial model across CRM architecture, market segmentation, enterprise targeting, outbound methodology, messaging, tenders, pipeline management and BDR development.
- Enterprise development: originated and developed the ADA International opportunity, contributing to a £2m+ logistics contract spanning UK and German operations, alongside additional major e-commerce opportunities.
- Commercial transformation: supported the evolution of ICP's UK operation from approximately six smaller 3PL clients and 80,000 sq. ft. toward a larger multinational portfolio and 300,000 sq. ft. operation during a period of approximately 300-400% overall UK business growth.
- Talent development: recruited, trained and developed 30+ recruitment consultants at DRC Locums, with several progressing to become high-performing billers and key contributors to the business.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder

Meridian Elevate | May 2026 - Present | London, United Kingdom

Founded Meridian Elevate to help established international businesses build the UK commercial foundations required to compete on capability and value rather than geography and price alone.

- Developing a UK market-entry and representation model addressing recurring barriers including local credibility, communication, account management, buyer confidence and commercial infrastructure.
- Initial focus on high-capability businesses across Asia whose technical expertise can be undervalued when international competition is reduced to a race on quotation.
- Brings together first-hand UK market-development experience with practical commercial execution rather than advisory-only market-entry support.

Commercial & Learning Development Consultant

Independent | May 2021 - May 2026

Provided independent consulting across sales operations, commercial performance, training and organisational development.

- Assessed commercial structures, pipeline behaviour and conversion performance to identify operational weaknesses and opportunities for improvement.
- Supported sales-process improvement, management-level commercial analysis, team training and development, and business development methodology.
- Applied a data-first approach before examining the people, behaviours and culture behind performance patterns - an approach that increasingly reinforced a preference for direct commercial execution.

UK Business Development Director

ICP Logística | Oct 2017 - May 2021

Led the development and execution of UK commercial strategy for the Spanish 4PL logistics group, progressively taking wider control of the commercial function as the revised operating model produced stronger pipeline quality and enterprise opportunities.

- Rebuilt core commercial foundations including CRM architecture, database segmentation, target-account selection, outbound strategy, messaging, email templates, pitches, proposals, tenders and pipeline management.
- Introduced a more intelligence-led approach to opportunity development, analysing sectors, competitors, company size, fulfilment complexity, incumbent providers, pain points, contract cycles, growth signals and decision-making structures.
- Led a lean UK business development team of typically 2-3 BDRs, with hands-on responsibility for account allocation, prospect research, call coaching, messaging, KPI design, metrics management, CRM discipline, pipeline reviews and individual development.
- Originated and developed the ADA International opportunity, contributing to a £2m+ B2B logistics contract spanning UK and Germany; also developed additional major e-commerce opportunities and accounts.
- During tenure, the UK operation expanded from approximately 80,000 to 300,000 sq. ft. and moved from a small-client 3PL portfolio toward larger enterprise and multinational accounts, alongside the introduction of automated logistics.

EARLIER CAREER & COMMERCIAL METHODOLOGY

Head of Training & Talent Acquisition

DRC Locums Limited | Sep 2014 - Jan 2017

Progressed into responsibility for recruiting, training and developing commercial talent, with a live recruitment desk operating as both a training hub and incubator for new consultants.

- Recruited, trained and developed 30+ recruitment consultants, with several progressing to become high-performing billers and key contributors within the organisation.
- Designed and delivered practical development across business development, candidate acquisition, telephone engagement, relationship building and commercial discipline.
- Developed an early operating philosophy that sales teams perform best when people are aligned to the stages of the commercial process where their strengths and learning styles create the greatest value.

Senior Headhunter - Radiology

DRC Locums Limited | Dec 2013 - Aug 2014

Specialised in identifying and engaging scarce, high-value Radiology Consultants within a competitive healthcare recruitment market. Strong specialist candidate acquisition and an ability to communicate effective recruitment methodology led to progression into training and talent development within approximately nine months.

Chef

Macdonald Hotels & Resorts, Marlow | Dec 2011 - Dec 2013

Early career in a high-pressure hospitality environment requiring consistency, teamwork and disciplined execution.

COMMERCIAL OPERATING PHILOSOPHY

Data-led diagnosis. Begins with commercial evidence - pipeline behaviour, conversion patterns, activity and operational performance - before drawing conclusions about the cause. Human factors such as team structure, capability, incentives, culture and stakeholder behaviour are then examined against the data.

Commercial systems thinking. Views revenue teams as interconnected systems rather than linear career ladders. Individuals are most effective when their capabilities are aligned to the part of the commercial process where they create the greatest value, with specialist functions operating as complementary components of the wider revenue engine.

Opportunity & stakeholder insight. Looks beyond stated requirements and job titles to understand what has changed inside an organisation, who or what is affected, and what individual stakeholders are trying to achieve. Propositions can then be built around the underlying business case rather than price or feature-led selling.

Commercial Strategy & International Business Development | London, United Kingdom | charlie@meridianelevate.co.uk